

Productive Dashboard — User Manual

What is this app? Productive Dashboard is a personal productivity web app that works on both desktop and mobile (installable as a PWA — Progressive Web App). It combines a focus timer, weekly schedule, task tracking, habit health logs, goals roadmap, notes, leaderboard, and a friends system — all synced to the cloud so your data follows you everywhere.

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0. Installing the App on Your Device

This app is a **PWA (Progressive Web App)** — it installs like a native app directly from your browser. No app store needed.

On Mobile (Android — Chrome)

1. Open the app URL in **Chrome**.
2. Tap the **three-dot menu (⋮)** at the top-right corner of Chrome.
3. Tap **"Add to Home screen"** or **"Install app"**.
4. A prompt appears — tap **"Install"** or **"Add"**.
5. The app icon appears on your home screen. Tap it to open the app in full-screen, just like a native app — no browser bar visible.

On Mobile (iOS — Safari)

1. Open the app URL in **Safari** (must be Safari, not Chrome, on iPhone).
2. Tap the **Share button** (box with arrow pointing up) at the bottom of the screen.
3. Scroll down and tap **"Add to Home Screen"**.
4. Tap **"Add"** in the top-right.
5. The icon appears on your home screen.

On Desktop (Chrome / Edge)

1. Open the app URL in **Chrome** or **Edge**.
2. Look for the **install icon** (computer screen with a down-arrow) in the browser's address bar on the right side.
3. Click it → click **"Install"** in the popup.
4. The app opens in its own window (no browser tabs, no address bar) — feels like a desktop app.
5. It also appears in your Start Menu / taskbar like any other installed app.

Tip: If you don't see the install icon in the address bar, try the three-dot menu (⋮) at the top-right → look for **"Install Productive Dashboard"** or **"Cast, save, and share → Install page as app"**.

Using the App Offline & Sync Behaviour

The app is designed to keep working even when your internet connection drops.

What works without internet

- The **Focus Timer** runs entirely on-device. It will not stop, pause, or lose time if you go offline.
- **Tasks, Notes, Timetable, Plans, Countdowns** — you can view and edit all of them. Changes are saved locally in your browser instantly.

- **Health logs, Stats** — readable and writable offline.

What requires internet

- **Logging in / registering** — needs internet for the OTP and authentication.
- **Leaderboard, Friends, Broadcasts** — these pull live data from the server.
- **Cloud Sync (saving to cloud)** — write operations are queued and pushed when internet returns.

How sync works

Your data is saved to your browser first (instant, always works), and then pushed to the cloud server in the background.

- If you edit something while offline, it is stored locally.
- When internet reconnects, the app automatically detects this and pushes the pending data to the cloud.
- **You will not lose data** by going offline mid-session. The timer, for example, auto-saves focus minutes every 10 minutes and catches up on reconnect.

Important: Data lives in your browser's local storage AND the cloud. If you clear your browser data / use a different browser without logging in, your local copy is gone — but the cloud copy is safe. Logging in on any device restores your data from the cloud.

1. First Launch — Login / Register Screen

When you open the app for the first time, you will land on the **Login screen**, not the dashboard. You must create an account or log in before anything else is accessible.

Registering a New Account

1. Click "**Need an account? Register**" on the login screen.
2. Fill in: **Email, Username, Password**.
3. Submit — a **6-digit OTP** is sent to your email (check spam if not visible).
4. Enter the OTP on the next screen to verify your email.

If the app gets stuck on a "Syncing..." or loading screen after registration: This is a known first-load quirk. Simply **close the browser tab / app window completely and reopen it**. Then log in normally with your username and password. Your account is already created — do not register again.

Logging In

- Enter your **Username or Email + Password** → Login.

Forgot Password

1. Click "Forgot Password?" on the login screen.
2. Enter your registered email → an OTP is sent.
3. Enter the OTP + your new password → done. Then log in.

2. The Dashboard Layout

After login, you see the main dashboard — a full-screen wallpaper with floating widgets.

- **Bottom Dock** — quick-launch buttons for Timer, Tasks, Notes, Plans, Stats, Calendar, Timetable, etc.
- **Right Toolbar** — Health, Stopwatch, and other secondary widgets.
- **Draggable Widgets** — Clock, Calendar, Timer, Countdowns, Quote. Drag them anywhere.
- **Settings** (⚙️) — accessed via the dock or toolbar, contains all configuration.

3. Account & Cloud Sync (Connect Tab)

Go to **Settings** → **Connect & News** after login.

Inside the Connect tab there are four sub-tabs: **Profile**, **Friends**, **News**, **Ranks**.

Profile Tab

- Displays your username and a green **Sync Active** badge when cloud sync is working.
- **Avatar**: Paste any public image URL (e.g. from imgur) → Save.
- **Alias**: Unlock with your password → set a nickname shown on the leaderboard instead of your real username.
- **Sign Out** and **Delete Account** are both here. Delete requires unlocking first.

⚠️ **90-Day Inactivity Warning**: Accounts with no logins for 90 days are **permanently deleted** along with all data. Export your backup regularly via **Settings** → **Data & Backup**.

4. Focus Timer

The **Timer widget** sits on the main dashboard and is draggable.

Starting the Timer

Method	How
Quick preset	Click 5m , 15m , or 25m button
Custom minutes	Type a number in the "Custom mins..." box → press Set or Enter
Click the display	When idle (showing 00:00), click the big digits to open the editor and set hours:minutes manually

Controls while running

- ▶ / ⏸ — Start or Pause
- ■ — Stop/Reset — saves any focus minutes already earned, then resets

What happens if you cancel in the middle?

If you press **Reset** mid-session, the app does **not lose your time**. Any minutes elapsed are saved to your focus history before the timer clears.

Example: Timer set to 45 min. You stop it at 20 min. Those 20 minutes are saved to today's focus log immediately.

Auto-save while running (internet loss protection)

The timer saves progress **every 10 minutes automatically** as you work — no internet required for the countdown itself. The saving happens in the background.

- If you lose internet mid-session, the timer **keeps running locally** — it does not stop.
- When internet returns, the next 10-minute checkpoint or the final save (on reset/finish) will sync to the cloud.
- You will **never lose a completed or partially-done session** due to a connection drop.

Example: 45-min session. At 10 min → auto-saves 10 min. At 20 min → saves 10 more. Internet drops at 25 min. Timer keeps going. At 30 min → tries to save, queued. Internet returns. At finish → saves remaining 15 min. Total: 45 min logged correctly.

Linking Timer to a Task

From the **Tasks** panel, click the ► button next to any task. The timer starts and tracks focus time specifically for that task. The task name appears in a blue label above the timer display.

When the timer finishes

- Alarm plays (if enabled in Settings → Sound).
- A motivational quote popup appears.
- All minutes for the session are recorded to your Stats.

5. Stats (Focus History)

Open via the  **Stats** button on the dock/toolbar.

Left panel:

- **Today's Focus** — minutes logged today
- **All Time** — total ever logged
- **7-Day Avg / 30-Day Avg** — daily averages for recent periods
- **Days Logged** — number of days you've used the timer

Right panel — Monthly Breakdown:

- Lists all months, sorted newest first.
- Click any month row to expand it → shows individual day entries.
- Each day entry also shows **Academic / Reading / Vocab** minutes if you logged Health data that day.

6. Tasks

Open from the dock. Add tasks with a title, optional due date, and time estimate.

- Press ► on any task to link it to the Focus Timer.
 - Check off tasks when done.
 - Tasks with deadlines near the alert threshold trigger a banner popup on the dashboard (configure in Settings → Preferences → Deadline Alerts).
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7. Calendar & Deadlines

The **Mini Calendar** is a draggable widget on the dashboard.

Adding a Deadline to a Date

1. Click any **date** on the calendar grid.
2. The view switches to that day's deadline list.
3. Click "+ **ADD DEADLINE**" at the bottom.
4. Type the deadline name/note directly in the new text field → press **Enter** or click away to save.
5. To edit a saved deadline: **double-click** the text.
6. To delete: click the 🗑 trash icon next to it.

Dates with deadlines show a **red dot** on the calendar. If a deadline falls on today, the dot pulses.

View All Deadlines

Click "**VIEW ALL DEADLINES**" at the bottom of the calendar widget to see a sorted list of every deadline across all dates.

Deadline Alert Notifications

Go to **Settings** → **Preferences** → **Deadline Alerts**.

Set the number of days in advance you want an alert popup. Example: set to **3** — if a deadline is in 3 days or less, a warning banner appears automatically on the dashboard each time you open the app.

8. Timetable

A weekly schedule grid. Open from the dock or toolbar.

Basic use

- **Weekdays / Weekends** — toggle using the < > arrows on either side of the title.
- Today's column is highlighted in purple automatically.
- Click any cell → type the subject or activity (e.g. "Maths", "Gym") → press Tab or click away to save.
- If you type the **exact same text** in back-to-back rows of the same day, those cells visually merge into one block automatically.

How the time column works

The time column on the left is **fully automatic** — you never type times manually. It works like this:

1. You set a **Day Start Time** (e.g. 8:00 AM).
2. Each row has a **duration** (e.g. 60 min).
3. The app calculates every slot's start and end time by adding durations top-to-bottom from your start time.

Example: Start = 8:00 AM. Row 1 = 60 min → shows 8:00AM – 9:00AM. Row 2 = 90 min → shows 9:00AM – 10:30AM. Row 3 = 60 min → shows 10:30AM – 11:30AM. You only needed to set durations; the times adjust automatically.

This means: If you change any row's duration, all rows below it shift their times automatically. The clock column always stays correct.

Setting the Day Start Time

Click the small **"Day Starts: 9:00 AM"** button just below the title. A time picker appears → choose your time → Save.

- This is saved separately for **Weekdays** and **Weekends**.

What if day starts 1 hour early/late? Just click the Day Starts button and correct the time. All row times recalculate instantly with no manual editing needed.

Changing a slot's duration

Click any **time cell** in the left column:

- A small editor pops up on that cell.
- Use ▲ **+15** / ▼ **-15** to adjust in 15-minute steps, or type a number directly (in minutes).
- Press ✓ or Enter to confirm.
- All subsequent row times update automatically.

Example: Row 1 is 60 min. Click it → change to 90 → confirm. Row 1 now shows 8:00AM – 9:30AM and Row 2 shifts to start at 9:30AM.

Adding / Removing rows

Click the ⚙ settings icon next to the schedule title:

Option	What it does
Add Top Row	Adds a new slot before row 1 and shifts day start back by 1 hr
Add Bottom Row	Adds a new slot at the end
Delete Top Row	Removes row 1 and moves day start forward
Delete Bottom Row	Removes the last row

9. Focus Mode & Panic Mode

Desktop — Keyboard Shortcuts

Configure shortcuts in **Settings** → **Focus / Panic Mode**.

Mode	What it does
Focus Mode	Hides the widgets you selected in the "Focus Specific Setup" section. Press again to restore.
Panic Mode	Instantly hides ALL widgets. Press again to restore. - Click the shortcut input box → press your desired key combo (e.g. Ctrl + H) → it saves automatically. - You can also click "Trigger" button to test it manually. Switch Wallpaper on Panic — toggle ON if you want the wallpaper to also change when Panic is triggered.

Mobile — Eye Icon Panic

On mobile, there is no keyboard. Instead:

- Look for the **👁 Eye icon** on the right side of the screen.
- Tap it to trigger the Panic action instantly.

Panic Action has two modes (set in Settings → Focus / Panic Mode → Panic Action):

Mode	What happens
Redirect	The browser immediately navigates to a random/neutral website, making the dashboard completely invisible to anyone looking. To return: press Back in the browser — the dashboard reloads and your session is still active.
Hide UI	All widgets disappear and the screen goes transparent/blank. Tap the eye icon again to bring everything back.

Summary for mobile: Tap 👁 → screen redirects or goes blank. To get back → tap browser Back (redirect mode) or tap the eye area again (hide mode).

11. Friends

Settings → **Connect & News** → **Friends tab** (requires login).

Adding a Friend

- Use the **search bar** to find users by username.
- Click **Send Request** next to their name.
- They will see a pending request badge on their Friends tab.

Accepting / Rejecting Requests

- A red number badge on the Friends tab shows pending incoming requests.
- Tap the request to **Accept** ✓ or **Reject** X.

Viewing Friend Stats

- In your friends list, click the  **Stats** icon next to a friend's name.
- A panel opens showing their focus history — today's time, total time, and daily breakdown by month.
- Click "**My Stats**" button to view your own stats in the same view.

Removing a Friend

Click the  trash icon next to any friend → confirm.

12. Leaderboard

Settings → **Connect & News** → **Ranks tab** (requires login).

- Shows all users ranked by focus time for **Today / This Week / This Month** — toggle at the top.
- Your own row is highlighted.
- Your **alias** is shown if you set one; otherwise your username is shown.
- Use the search bar to find a specific user.
- Click any user row to expand and see their stats breakdown.

Set your alias in **Settings** → **Connect** → **Profile** → **Security & Alias** (requires password unlock) to appear anonymously on the leaderboard.

13. Plans (Pending Works / Roadmap)

Open from the dock. Plan long-term goals broken into actionable steps.

- **Add Plan:** Title + Category + Duration (plain text like "30 days") + Target End Date.
 - Each plan card shows a **Days Left / Due Today / Overdue** badge and a completion progress bar.
 - Click a plan card → open it → add **Action Items** (sub-topics).
 - Click an action item to check/uncheck it. Progress updates instantly.
 - Filter plans by category using the dropdown in the top-right.
 - To delete a plan: open it → click "**Drop Plan**" at the bottom-left.
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14. Quick Notes

Open from the dock. A simple scratchpad.

- Create multiple notes, each with a title and body text.
 - Notes are cloud-synced automatically.
 - Export any note as a **.txt** file using the download button.
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15. Health Tracker

Open via the  icon on the right toolbar.

Log daily metrics:

- **Academic minutes** — formal study time

- **Reading minutes** — books, articles
- **Vocab words** — new English words learned

These feed into the monthly breakdown in Stats, shown alongside focus time.

16. Stopwatch

Separate from the Focus Timer. Records raw elapsed time.

- Start, Pause, Lap, Reset.
 - Each session is saved with its timestamp and visible in Stats history.
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17. Countdowns

A widget showing a list of upcoming events with day countdowns.

- Add an event name + target date.
 - Widget shows "X days left" for each.
 - Events within your **Deadline Alert Days** threshold show a dashboard popup banner.
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18. Wallpapers

Settings → **Wallpapers**

- Pick from built-in wallpapers (images + animated videos).
 - Upload custom wallpapers via URL (separate sets for **Desktop** and **Mobile**, up to 4 each).
 - Click a wallpaper thumbnail to make it active.
 - **Slideshow mode** — auto-cycles through wallpapers at a set interval (in minutes).
 - **Lock a wallpaper** — slideshow will skip it; it stays permanent until unlocked.
 - **Hide** a wallpaper from the rotation without deleting it.
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19. Widget Settings

Settings → **Preferences**

- **Widget Visibility** — toggle any widget on or off (Timer, Clock, Calendar, Tasks, Notes, Timetable, Health, Stats, etc.)
 - **Widget Drag Locking** — prevent specific widgets from being moved accidentally. Toggle per widget.
 - **Reset Default Positions** — resets all draggable widgets back to their original layout positions.
 - **Right Toolbar Position** — adjust the vertical height offset of the right toolbar.
 - **24-Hour Clock** — toggle between 12h AM/PM and 24h military format.
 - **Deadline Alert Days** — how many days before a deadline the alert popup triggers.
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20. Sound Settings

Settings → **Sound Settings**

- **Enable Alarm Sound** — plays audio when timer ends.
- **Enable Device Vibrate** — vibrates phone when timer ends (mobile only).
- **Auto Stop Timer** — slider from 5 seconds to 2 minutes. Controls how long the alarm rings before stopping itself.
- **Select Alarm Sound** — choose from available ringtones.

21. Data & Backup

Settings → Data & Backup

- **Export Data** — downloads a full **.json** backup of all your data. Requires being logged in.
- **Import Data** — upload a **.json** backup file.
 - **Merge:** Combines the backup with your existing data (no data lost from either side).
 - **Overwrite:** Replaces everything with the backup file.
- **Clear Old Data** — delete focus history entries older than a chosen number of days.
- **Clear All Data** — wipes all local data (irreversible).

22. Feedback & Bugs

Settings → Feedback & Bugs

- Submit:  **Feature request**,  **Bug report**, or  **General feedback**.
- View your submission status:
 - *Reviewing* — received, not yet looked at
 - *Reviewed* — seen by developer
 - *✓ Roadmap!* — accepted and planned

Quick Reference

What you want to do	Where
Start focus timer	Timer widget on dashboard
See your focus logs	 Stats button on dock
Set weekly schedule	Timetable (dock)
Add a deadline to a date	Click the date on the Calendar widget
Set deadline alert threshold	Settings → Preferences → Deadline Alerts
Plan long-term goals	Plans / Roadmap (dock)
Check the leaderboard	Settings → Connect → Ranks tab
Add / accept friends	Settings → Connect → Friends tab
View a friend's stats	Friends tab →  icon next to their name
Backup your data	Settings → Data & Backup → Export

What you want to do	Where
Change wallpaper	Settings → Wallpapers
Hide/show widgets	Settings → Preferences → Widget Visibility
Lock widgets in place	Settings → Preferences → Widget Drag Locking
Panic button (mobile)	Tap  Eye icon on right side of screen
Panic / Focus shortcut (desktop)	Settings → Focus / Panic Mode
Set alias for leaderboard	Settings → Connect → Profile → Security & Alias
Reset password	Login screen → "Forgot Password?"